Chung-Yen Lo

Department of Economics, Indiana University Bloomington | Wylie Hall 310 Indiana University Bloomington, IN 47405
cl86@iu.edu | chungyenlo.github.io

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Indiana University, Bloomington — Expected May 2027
M.A. in International Trade, National Chengchi University, Taiwan — 2018
B.B.A. in Banking and Finance, National Chinan University, Taiwan — 2016

Fields

Industrial Organization, Applied Microeconomics

Job Market Paper

Concentration without Greater Market Power? Evidence from U.S. Sugar's Acquisition of Imperial Sugar

Draft upon request

Abstract: This paper examines whether a merger between sugar refiners affects competition in the retail markets where their brands compete. I study U.S. Sugar's acquisition of Imperial Sugar, announced in March 2021, using NielsenIQ Retail Scanner data from 2016 to 2022. A difference-in-differences design comparing the Southeast, where the merging firms' refining capacity is concentrated, with other regions finds no relative increase in retail prices following the announcement. I then estimate a mixed logit demand model and recover markups and marginal costs under multiproduct Bertrand competition. Substitution is spread across many competing brands rather than concentrated among the merging parties' products. Taking the ownership changes as known, a counterfactual decomposition separates the ownership and cost channels within a common demand environment. The change in ownership raises equilibrium prices by 0.03 percent and leaves markups, profits, consumer surplus, and welfare essentially unchanged, while differences between the pre- and post-announcement cost environments lower prices by 0.4 percent and markups by 2.1 percent. The merging firms together account for under 4 percent of retail volume, and private label, priced by retailers, accounts for most of the category, so the transaction alters the ownership of only a small share of the products consumers choose among. The results suggest that the competitive consequences of a merger among producers depend less on the change in producer concentration than on how much of the consumer-facing market the merging firms control and on how readily buyers substitute between the products they own.

Publications

To make or to buy from a common supplier? Strategic considerations and welfare consequences

with Wei-Jen Wen and Wen-Chien Lee, *International Journal of Economic Theory*, Vol. 19(1), 2022

Working Papers

Diabetes Diagnosis and Household Purchases of Sugary Products

The Consumer Surplus Neutral Threshold of Cost Synergies for Horizontal Mergers in the Cournot Competition

Work in Progress

Lobbying-Induced Misallocation and Aggregate Productivity

Fellowships and Awards

Graduate Assistantship, Department of Economics, Indiana University 2020-Present

Presentations

Hoosier Economics Conference, Indiana University April 2023
The Consumer Surplus Neutral Threshold of Cost Synergies for Horizontal Mergers under Cournot Competition

Teaching Experience

Instructor (Indiana University)

Fundamentals of Economics for Business I	Spring, Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant (Indiana University)

Fundamentals of Economics for Business I	Spring 2021–2024, 2026; Fall 2022–2024
Statistical Analysis for Business and Economics	Summer 2025
Fundamentals of Economics for Business II	Fall 2021
Introduction to Macroeconomics	Spring 2021
Statistics	Fall 2020

Research Experience

Research Assistant to the Regional Development Study Center, Chung-Hua Institution for Economic Research 2018-2019
Research Assistant to Prof. Wen-Chien Lee, National Chengchi University 2016-2018

Skills and Personal Information

Programming: R, Python, MATLAB, Maple, LaTeX
Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin (native)

References

Prof. Ruli Xiao (Chair)
Department of Economics
Indiana University
rulixiao@iu.edu

Prof. Yuki Ito
Department of Economics
Indiana University
yukiito@iu.edu

Prof. Emerson C. Melo
Department of Economics
Indiana University
emelo@iu.edu

Prof. Gustavo Torrens
Department of Economics
Indiana University
gtorrens@iu.edu